

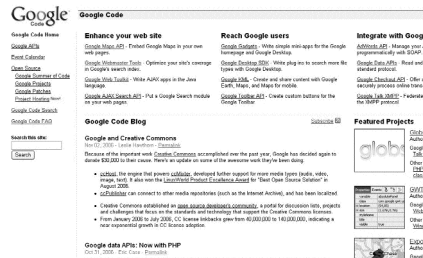
Google Code

Google Code (<http://code.google.com>) has been started as an Open source project. Here, the company releases the code for useful pieces of Google software for developers interested in Google technologies. For an enthusiast, nothing could have been better! Google first released the code for four projects—Perftools, sparsehashtable, coredumper and goopy/functional. The list has since expanded, and you can find it at <http://code.google.com/projects.html>. It is also hoped (and has been indicated) that existing Google programs like Google Toolbar, Google Talk and Google Desktop might be made open source.

1.1 Google And Open Source

In recent times, Google has done its bit for the open source movement, including a partnership with Sun Microsystems to help share and distribute each other's technologies. As part of the partnership, Google will hire programmers to help with the open source office program OpenOffice.org.

The company has also made a \$350,000 (Rs 1.65 crore) contribution to a joint open source technology initiative of Oregon State University and Portland State University. The aim is to encourage open source software and hardware development, and provide computing infrastructure to open source projects worldwide. Apart from this, Google organized a



The Google Code main window

\$2 million (Rs 9.5 crore) “Summer of Code” program to offer students an opportunity to work on technical projects. The competition attracted participants from over 90 countries; they completed various open source projects, and also received grants. Google is also involved with various organisations such as the Free Software Foundation, the Java Community Process, the Mozilla Foundation, OSDL, and the Python Software Foundation.

1.2 Google Code

Google uses code.google.com to publish not just its free source code but also a list of API services. APIs give developers a set of functions they can use to extend their program's functionality, without actually releasing code to them. For example, you can implement the Blogger API on your site to let users blog content from it without Google having to release any code to you.

The site itself is very simple in its interface, as are all Google products. It can be divided into the following.

1. The site navigation links: these enable users to navigate to more specific information. It also has a search function. Some of the links are Google APIs, Event Calendar, Open Source, Google Code Search, and the Google Code FAQ.
2. Enhance your Web site: these lists tools that allow users to use Google tools to provide many advanced features, and also certain new techniques. For example, Google Webmaster Tools optimise the user's site coverage in the search engine's index.
3. Reach Google users: this has tools that let programmers work on improving certain features of a known Google product. For example, writing a plugin with Google Desktop SDK to search more filetypes with Google Desktop.
4. Integrate with Google: these tools allow programmers to